

Research Question 9

Achievement Gap

Question

Does the policy help close the gap between students with lower prior GPAs and high achievers?

Graph 1 — Extensions by GPA

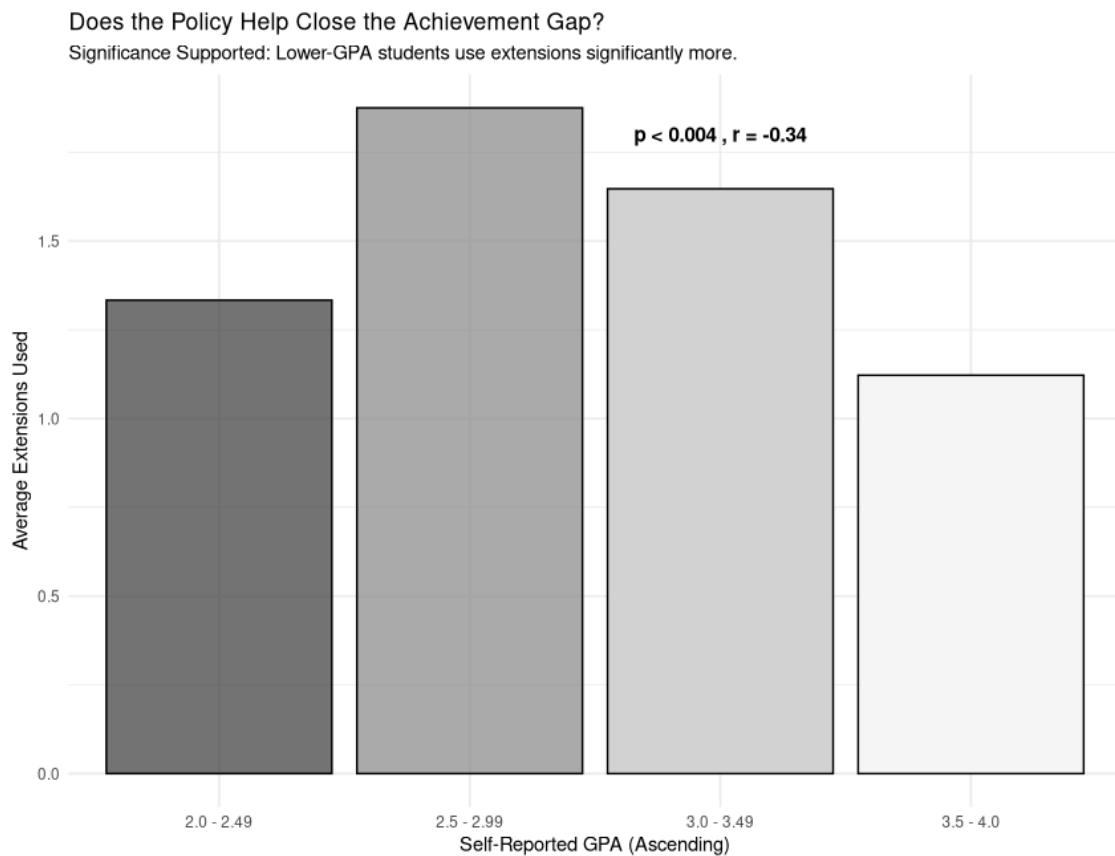


Figure 1: Average extensions used per GPA range.

Graph 1 Description

Bar chart — Average number of extensions used per GPA range.

X-axis: Self-reported GPA (ascending)

Y-axis: Average extensions used

Graph 2 — Final Grade by GPA

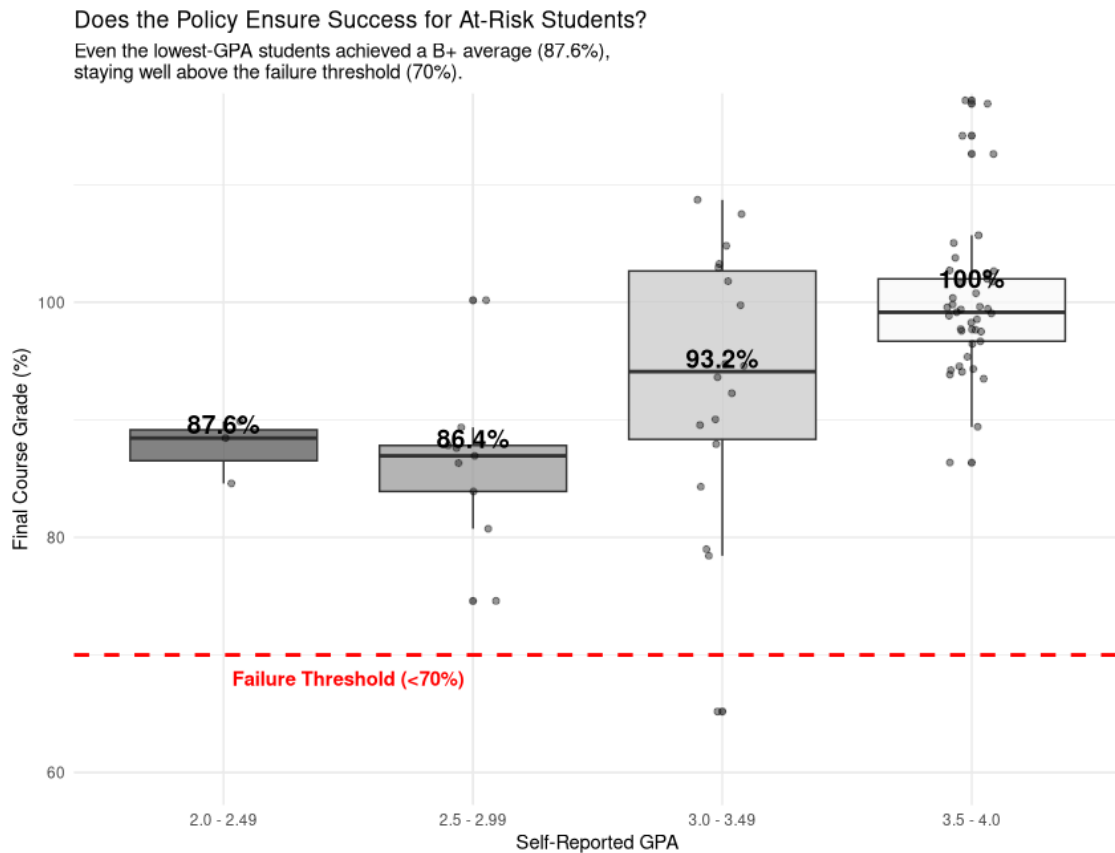


Figure 2: Final course grade (%) per GPA range, with failure threshold.

Graph Description

Boxplot with jitter — Final course grade (%) per GPA range.

X-axis: Self-reported GPA

Y-axis: Final course grade (%)

Mean score labels shown above each box. Red dashed line at $y = 70$ (failure threshold).

Raw Values Summary (for Graph 2)

1. The 2.0 — 2.49 GPA Group (count: 3) had a mean score of 87.6
2. The 2.5 — 2.99 GPA Group (count: 9) had a mean score of 86.9
3. The 3.0 — 3.49 GPA Group (count: 18) had a mean score of 93.2
4. The 3.5 — 4.0 GPA Group (count: 41) had a mean score of 100.0

Statistical Note

Test used: Spearman Correlation (Graph 1)

Result:

$$p < 0.004, r = -0.34$$

Conclusion

A significant correlation is shown: as a student's self-report of their GPA lowers, the higher amount of extensions they will use. Due to our smaller amount of data ($n = 105$), the graph does not seem to show much of a difference. To prove that the extension policy helps students who have a lower self-reported GPA, the second graph shows that the 2 lower GPA groups still got around an 85% as their Final Grade, which is still a good grade in our University.